Elaine Fjelstad Memorial Scholarship Fund



Background:
Elaine (Thompson) Fjelstad was born in 1941 and raised on a farm near Retreat, Wisconsin. She graduated with honors from De Soto High School in 1959 and was the first member of her family to graduate from college, receiving her Degree in Education in 1963 from UW-La Crosse. She had an outstanding work ethic from a young age and put her best effort forward in everything she did. Elaine was a strong, intelligent woman with a calm and caring nature. Teaching was her passion, and her passion touched countless lives over the years. Her students will always remember her as their fourth-grade teacher who brought history alive with her readings of the "Little House on the Prairie" books.

Elaine was a loving wife and mother. She excelled at music, playing piano, and serving as a church organist for many years. Her Lutheran faith was important to her, and she was active in her church community until the final days of her life. She was frequently making meals or doing weekly grocery shopping for those with ailing health or sending notes of inspiration when times were tough. She always had cookies and coffee ready for guests and loved baking, Badger basketball, crossword puzzles, and attending her grandsons' music events. Elaine passed away in 2020 at the age of 79. Her family and friends established the scholarship to honor her memory and to encourage and support future generations of passionate, caring teachers.

Eligibility: (taken into consideration to determine recipients)

- Graduating seniors from the following Wisconsin High Schools:
  - Viroqua High School
  - De Soto High School
- Planning on attending an accredited 2- or 4-year college or university as a full-time student
- Pursuing a degree in Education, History, English, Literature or STEM related field
- Preference will be given to students who pursue Education or Elementary Education
- Minimum cumulative 3.0 GPA
- Participation in working, extracurricular, and/or community experiences that have: Confirmed a passion for working with children (ex. tutor, Sunday school teacher, coach, activity director, etc.) and/or exemplified kindness and service to others

Award Amount:
Two $750 non-renewable scholarship awards for cost of attendance, payable for the fall semester.

Selection:
Recipients are recommended each spring by the Community Foundation for the Fox Valley Region Scholarship Selection Committee and a family member.

Collecting the Award & Payment Procedure:
Recipients must fill out and submit Scholarship Acceptance Form and Scholarship Verification Form through the Scholarship Portal *(https://www.grantinterface.com/Home/Logon?urlkey=cffvrscholar)*. Recipients are required to provide supporting documents *as instructed* in the Scholarship Verification Form, such as class registration/list **with** credits listed, proof of major, grade transcript, etc.

After approval of online Scholarship Verification Form, the scholarship check will be paid directly to the school the recipient will be attending. The **Community Foundation communicates with students via email**; it is the student's responsibility to keep their Scholarship Portal account updated with their current email address.

Loss of Eligibility:
Failure to register as a full-time student pursuing a degree in Education, History, English, Literature or STEM related field for the fall semester of freshman year of college.

Further Information:

- Community Foundation for the Fox Valley Region
  - Website www.cffoxvalley.org/scholarships/
  - Email scholarships@cffoxvalley.org
  - Phone 920.702.7623